

Interview with David Lodola - India Research, 13th June 2025

Interviewee: David Lodola - Workday Services Enterprise Architect in India leading the Genpact implementation

My own notes from the interview

This summary outlines the business context of Genpact, a large professional services firm, and details the primary functional gaps in Workday Recruiting when applied to their high-volume, process-driven "Talent Supply Chain" in India.

Genpact's Business Context

- **Business Model:** Genpact operates like a machine, driven by projects. Their business is predominantly long-term outsourcing work (approx. 70-80%) and consulting (approx. 20%). They make money by staffing projects efficiently.
- **Scale & Operations:** The company has approximately 140,000 employees. A key strategy for talent retention and utilization is constantly rotating people between projects. The cost-effective labor pool in India is a major operational factor.
- **Internal Mobility is Core:** Internal staffing is the highest priority and accounts for roughly 60% of all roles filled. "Resource Managers" act as internal recruiters, making the connection between Workday Recruiting and Professional Services Automation (PSA) critical.

The Core Challenge: The "Talent Supply Chain"

David was brought in after a previous implementation partner's contract was cancelled. He found that Workday was operating in silos and could not support Genpact's interconnected "Talent Supply Chain."

To solve this, Genpact built a custom **Workday Extend application** to act as a bridge. This app captures project-based demand with fields that a standard Job Requisition has, plus additional project-specific fields (e.g., "Reason for short turnaround time?"). This creates a unified view of demand, which then informs the recruiting process.

Key Pain Points & Gaps in Workday Recruiting

1. Lack of Mass Action Functionality

- Genpact recruits "en masse," often for 100-200 openings at a time. The current process requires too many individual clicks.
- There is a major need for **mass processing capabilities** for offers, employment agreements, approvals, and sign-offs. They often have large batches of people starting on the same day.
- It was noted that they **do not use Workday's worksheets** for these processes.

2. Candidate Identification & Fraud (Know Your Candidate)

- A significant challenge in India is **candidate impersonation**, where the person who applies for a role is not the same person who shows up for the interview.
- There is a clear need for identity verification features, such as **facial recognition**, to ensure the integrity of the interview process.

3. Background Checks (BGC)

- BGC is fundamental to Genpact's business, not for internal policy, but as a **contractual obligation to their clients** whose projects involve sensitive data.
- Workday's native BGC integration capabilities are considered too basic. Genpact uses a middleware provider called **Tydy (recently acquired by Eightfold)** to manage this.
- **The Gap:** Tydy requires a comprehensive dataset. Genpact wants to collect all necessary BGC information from the candidate upfront in Workday to avoid a poor candidate experience where they have to enter the same information twice.

4. Data Auditability & Compliance

- A key compliance gap exists on the career site. Candidates can change critical personal information (name, address, phone number) with **very little tracking or auditability**.
- This poses a security risk, as it can be used to bypass background checks or facilitate the impersonation issues mentioned earlier.

5. Candidate Engagement & High Drop-Off Rate

- A high percentage of candidates accept offers but do not show up for their first day.
- To combat this, Genpact has purchased candidate messaging solutions to maintain a "high-touch" and engaging communication stream with candidates between offer acceptance and their start date.

The "Magic Wand" Request: Strategic Opportunity

When asked what he would change, David summarized the core need:

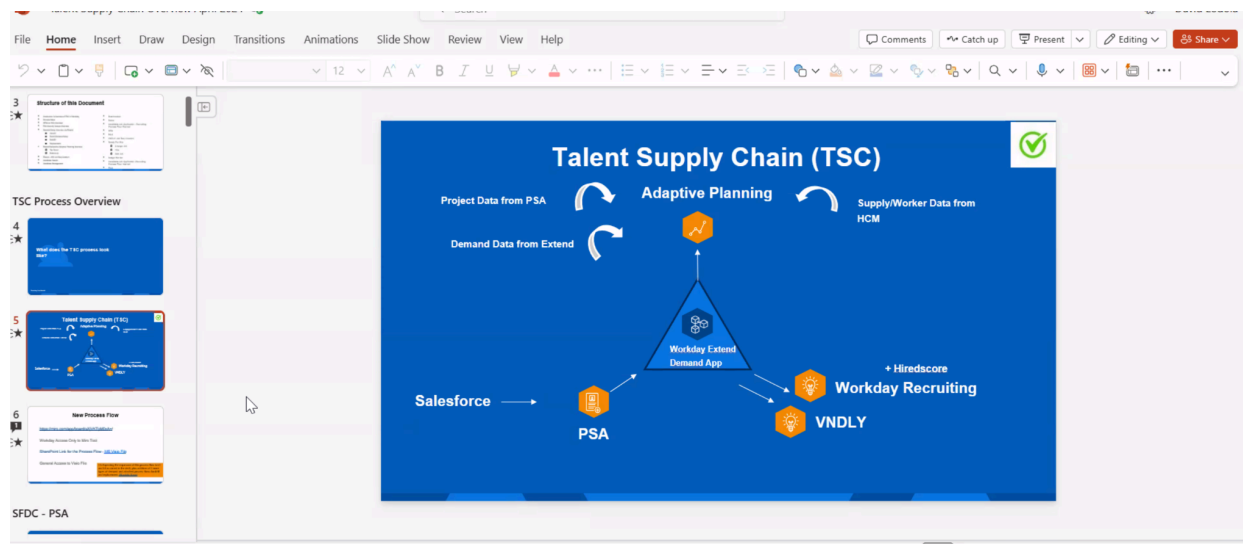
Give recruiters the ability to be more proactive and manage candidates "en masse," with full visibility into the entire talent supply chain.

This means unifying the view between **demand (from PSA/Projects)** and **supply (internal and external candidates)**, allowing Resource Managers and Recruiters to see who is available, who matches project needs, and who may be at risk of attrition.

Key Takeaways for Workday

1. **Resource Management IS Recruiting:** For project-based businesses like Genpact, the "Resource Manager" is a primary recruiting persona. We need to focus on a "Resource Management-Led Experience," enabling them to perform mass actions and gain better visibility into the talent pipeline directly from their project-focused view.
2. **"Industrial Scale" is a Feature Gap:** Our current tools are not optimized for the "en masse" reality of high-volume hiring. The lack of bulk processing for offers, approvals, and other steps is a significant source of friction.
3. **Trust & Compliance are Foundational:** For a B2B service provider like Genpact, features like BGC, KYC (Know Your Candidate), and data auditability are not "nice-to-haves"; they are fundamental, client-mandated requirements. Our product needs to support these complex needs more natively.

Additional resources:



Talent Supply Chain diagram David Lobola shared - a key point is ensuring workday Recruiting works "better together" with the rest of the suite. It was very silo'ed when he joined the project, this has improved, but Recruiting needs to support a Project lens better, by working better with the PSA product especially. Additionally, HireScore needs to support sourcing internal workers who are nearing the end dates of their projects better, to enable that rotation model that

GenPact have, where they have a preference to recruit internal workers for their next project rotation.

Zoom's AI Note-taking Summary

Gempak's End-to-End Project-Based Operations

David Lodola explained that Gempak operates end-to-end with full HDM, FIN, VNDLY, hired score, adaptive workforce planning, and six extend use cases, excluding benefits. He highlighted that Gempak's business model focuses on project-based work, with 70% in outsourcing and 20-30% in consulting, aiming for cost efficiency by rotating their large workforce of 140,000 employees. David Lodola noted that Gempak's approach to cost management differs from typical efficiency savings, as they often absorb costs by deploying a large number of cheaper labor resources.

Genpact's Scalable Recruitment System

David Lodola explained Genpact's talent supply chain, which integrates multiple systems including Workday, Taleo, Avature, and a homegrown Salesforce-based system called Matchmaker. He described how Genpact recruits at scale for project-based roles, prioritizing internal rotations and using adaptive planning to model workforce availability. The main gaps identified in the recruitment process include the need for more proactive recruiting and faster requisition processing at scale, as the current system works well for individual hires but struggles with large volume recruitment.

Genpact's Tydy Integration for Background Checks

David Lodola discussed Genpact's background check process, highlighting their use of Tydy, a middleware platform recently acquired by Eightfold, for conducting background checks on candidates for clients like Microsoft, Meta, and Pfizer. He explained that Genpact has developed a custom integration with Tydy to streamline the collection and transmission of candidate data, addressing the need for scale and efficiency. David also pointed out a compliance issue related to data changes on the career site, which poses challenges in verifying candidate identity and maintaining auditability.

Candidate Management System Updates

David Lodola explained the recruitment process, highlighting the use of a CRM-style system for managing large batches of candidates. He mentioned the need to investigate why worksheets functionality is not being used for mass approvals and reviews. David Lodola also discussed the importance of maintaining candidate engagement through the onboarding process, using new functionality for messaging and engagement.

Product Team Recruitment Alignment Challenges

David Lodola discussed the challenges in aligning product teams for recruitment and resource management, highlighting gaps in integrating project-related data and enabling recruiters to manage candidates en masse. He emphasized the need for better visibility into supply and demand, improved communication between product teams, and a shift towards a recruiter-led approach. David Lodola also noted that Gempact had descended on using Hired Score for internal candidates due to data limitations and the inability to visualize supply and demand on a single screen.